

Playoff Pregame: #6 Maple Tree vs #3 Bullseyes

Round 1 · Single elimination · Wednesday, June 17, 2026 · 7:30 PM · Boncosky Red (rescheduled from June 10 rainout)

The regular season was a 2-10 grind that bought exactly one thing: a ticket to a single-elimination tournament where the slate is clean and the matchup is winnable. Tonight that ticket gets cashed. Of all the teams left in this bracket, **Bullseyes is the one the data says you can beat** — the franchise owns them, and this lineup is built to exploit them. Win and the season gets another chapter at 8:30. Lose and it's over. One game, one good offensive night, and the 2-10 record becomes a footnote.

Game Setup

- **7:30 PM — Boncosky Red** (Game 3 of the bracket)
- Single elimination — no nightcap, no second game to give it back in
- Opponent: **Bullseyes** (#3 seed, 7-5 regular season)
- Win → **Game 5, 8:30 PM, Boncosky Red** vs the winner of #2 cacheouts and #7 Wasted Potential
- 11 available tonight — Duff and Slomka are off the card

Tonight's Lineup

This order is built for *this* opponent. The four highest career marks against Bullseyes are stacked one through four. Numbers below are **career vs Bullseyes** — the only sample that matters tonight.

#	Player	AVG	OBP	SLG	HR	RBI	OPS
1	Glove	.658	.675	.974	1	16	1.649
2	Tristan	.639	.675	1.833	14	36	2.508
3	Tim	.588	.632	1.706	6	15	2.338
4	Kives	.686	.694	1.286	4	22	1.980
5	JJ	.613	.700	.968	2	9	1.668
6	Porter	.594	.629	.906	1	7	1.535
7	Joel	.292	.346	.542	2	10	.888
8	Corey	.300	.382	.367	0	6	.749
9	Walsh	.500	.667	.500	0	1	1.167
10	Snaxx	.526	.550	.632	0	6	1.182
11	Jason	.348	.483	.348	0	3	.831

Slash line, HR, RBI, and OPS are career totals versus Bullseyes.

The construction is the whole point. The four highest career OPS marks against Bullseyes — Tristan (2.508), Tim (2.338), Kives (1.980), Glove (1.649) — hit one through four. JJ and his **.700 on-base** sit fifth. And the order correctly weighs **Porter's Bullseyes history (1.535) over Joel's better season number**, because against this team Joel is only .888. This is not a lineup sorted by season stats — it's sorted by who beats Bullseyes, and it gets that right top to bottom.

The Bullseyes Book

This is the encouraging part, and it isn't a pep talk — it's the record book. **The franchise is 6-4 all-time against Bullseyes with a +4 run differential** (150 scored, 146 allowed). They are one of the few opponents Maple Tree actually owns. You split with them this very spring — the 25-24 Week 2 slugfest and a 5-15 dud. This is not No Dice, who you've never beaten in ten tries. This is a beatable team you have already beaten.

Every Maple Tree meeting with Bullseyes the last two seasons:

Result	Score	Maple Tree runs
W	24-14	24
W	16-11	16
W	25-24	25 (this April)
L	13-14	13
L	10-15	10
L	8-20	8
L	5-15	5 (this April)

The pattern is almost insulting in its clarity: **score 16 or more and you beat Bullseyes; get held under 13 and you lose**. There is no in-between. The wins are 24, 16, 25. The losses are 13, 10, 8, 5. The whole game tonight is whether your bats clear a number you've cleared against this exact team three times already.

Keys Tonight

- **Score 16.** Not a vibe — a line drawn by seven games of history against this exact opponent. Your top four can get there in two innings.
- **Survive one crooked inning.** Every Bullseyes win over Maple Tree came on a single 14-, 15-, or 20-run rally. You don't need a shutout — you need to keep one inning from becoming the game.
- **It's one game.** The season-long killer was the nightcap collapse. There is no nightcap tonight. Nothing to give back. Empty the tank.

Records Live Tonight

The team counts playoff games toward records, so nothing is final and everything is in play:

- **Tim** owns the single-season doubles record at 10 — every double tonight extends it.
- **Tristan** is **four home runs** from his own 15-HR single-season record, and he's facing the team he has already hit **14 career home runs** against. A multi-homer night is on the table.
- **JJ** is **four walks** from the single-season walk record, and he runs a **.700 OBP against Bullseyes** specifically. They give him free passes.

The Stakes

Win and you're playing at 8:30 in Game 5, against the winner of #2 cacheouts and #7 Wasted Potential. Lose and a season that fought to a 2-10 finish ends tonight at Boncosky Red. That's the entire weight of it, and it sits on a number — 16 — that this lineup has cleared against this opponent before.

You're the 6 seed. You're also the better matchup play, with the better history, and a lineup engineered to do the one thing that beats Bullseyes. Score 16. Weather one inning. Leave it all out there. Go write the next chapter. **Let's go.**